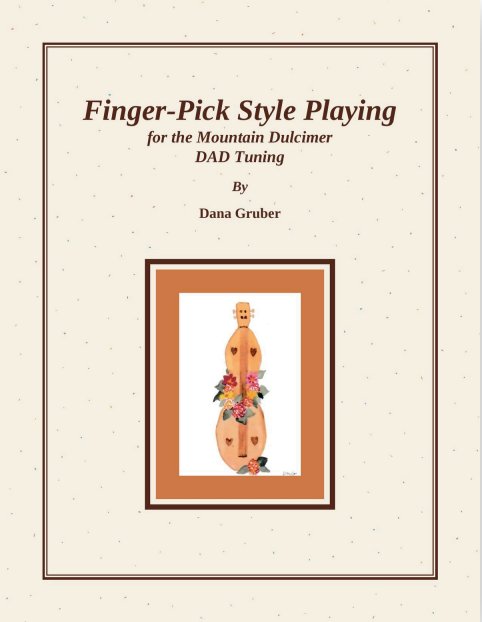
FINGERS OF STEEL® PUBLICATIONS

# Finger-Pick Style Playing

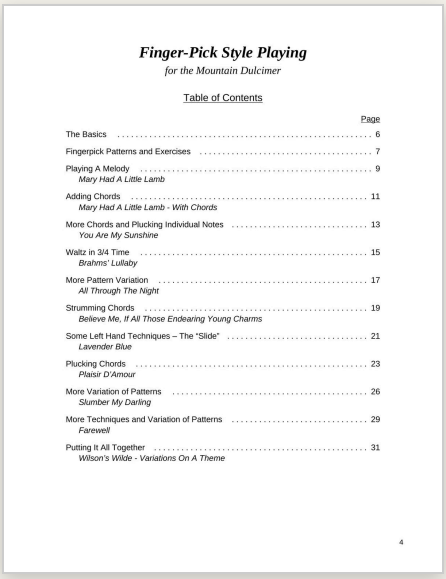
by Dana Gruber




Finger-Pick Style Playing is a fingerpicking method for mountain dulcimer by Dana Gruber. Every piece is a complete song, but each one is chosen to teach a specific skill, so the book builds your technique step by step. All songs are in DAD tuning.

27 pages

## INSIDE THE BOOK

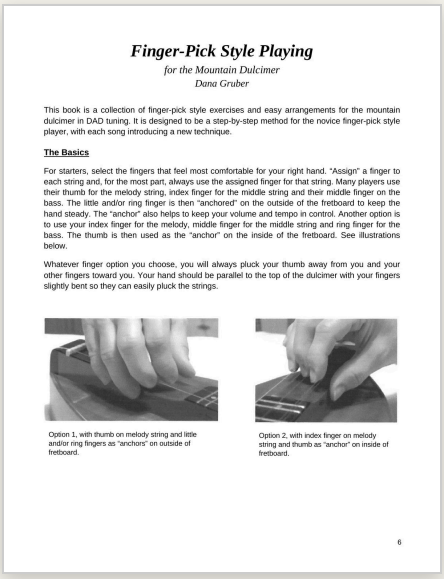


*Finger-Pick Style Playing*
*for the Mountain Dulcimer*

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*Finger-Pick Style Playing*
*for the Mountain Dulcimer*
*Dana Gruber*

This book is a collection of finger-pick style exercises and easy arrangements for the mountain dulcimer in DAD tuning. It is designed to be a step-by-step method for the novice finger-pick style player, with each song introducing a new technique.

**The Basics**

For starters, select the fingers that feel most comfortable for your right hand. "Assign" a finger to each string and, for the most part, always use the assigned finger for that string. Many players use their thumb for the melody string, index finger for the middle string and their middle finger on the bass. The little and/or ring finger is then "anchored" on the outside of the fretboard to keep the hand steady. The "anchor" also helps to keep your volume and tempo in control. Another option is to use your index finger for the melody, middle finger for the middle string and ring finger for the bass. The thumb is then used as the "anchor" on the inside of the fretboard. See illustrations below.

Whatever finger option you choose, you will always pluck your thumb away from you and your other fingers toward you. Your hand should be parallel to the top of the dulcimer with your fingers slightly bent so they can easily pluck the strings.

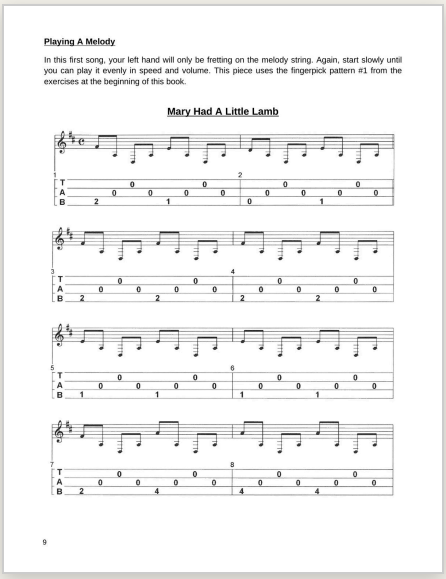


Option 1, with thumb on melody string and little and/or ring fingers as "anchors" on outside of fretboard.



Option 2, with index finger on melody string and thumb as "anchor" on inside of fretboard.

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**Playing A Melody**

In this first song, your left hand will only be fretting on the melody string. Again, start slowly until you can play it evenly in speed and volume. This piece uses the fingerpick pattern #1 from the exercises at the beginning of this book.

**Mary Had A Little Lamb**



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